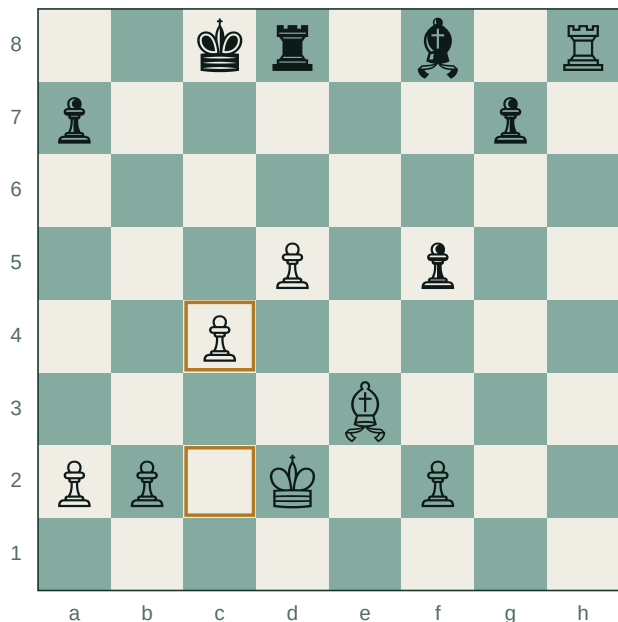


Discovered attacks: Black, move 25

Discovered attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 25.c4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25...Bb4+ 26. Kd3 Rxb8

25...Bb4+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on d8 attacks the rook on h8. Recorded reply: **26.Kd3**.

26...Rxb8 The rook captures the rook on h8.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on d2. Absolute pin: pawn on d5.